

Referring to EF|Health.

Psychological care for disorders of gut–brain interaction — what to refer, how to refer, and what comes back to you.

Dr Sarah Anticich · Clinical & Organisational Psychologist · The Executive Frame™

What it is

A stepped, outcome-measured psychological pathway for disorders of gut–brain interaction, delivered by Dr Sarah Anticich (Carson Psychology & Sarah Anticich Consulting) on behalf of MacMurray Centre. It treats the regulatory system driving gut dysfunction — hypervigilance, catastrophic interpretation, avoidance, reassurance cycling — alongside, and never instead of, your medical care.

Refer when you see

- IBS, functional dyspepsia, centrally-mediated abdominal pain, chronic nausea, or stress-sensitive motility symptoms.
- Persistent distress despite normal investigations and appropriate reassurance.
- Health anxiety, symptom hypervigilance, or repeat reassurance presentations.
- Food anxiety and avoidance (including ARFID-pattern), or activity and work avoidance.
- Pre- and post-surgical (including bariatric) adjustment; IBD with distress limiting function.

An adult service in v1 · a confirmed diagnosis is not required for the education and workshop tiers · patients do not need to accept a psychological framing to start.

Needs individual review first — not group

Active suicidal ideation or self-harm · current psychosis or acute severe mental illness · active severe eating disorder · significant unmanaged substance use or trauma instability. **EF|Health is not a crisis service** — acute risk goes to emergency care (111) or public mental health.

Referral to discharge, in five *moves*.

01 Refer with the smart referral form

A three-minute fillable PDF — details, presentation ticks, function rating, built-in risk screen — to consultant@sarahanticich.co.nz. Automatic acknowledgement to you; invitation and intake pack to the patient.

02 Triage within two business days

Online four-domain self-assessment (/64 — gut-focused anxiety · emotion sensitivity · health anxiety · functional impact) plus a red-flag screen. Score-assisted, clinician-decided — Dr Anticich is clinician of record for every allocation and escalation.

03 Allocation by band

Green > free education and self-guided tools · Amber > four-week group series · Orange > structured skills programme · Red or risk > individual psychology (CBT, ACT, CFT, gut-directed hypnotherapy). Shared medical–psychology sessions for complex and surgical patients.

04 Intervention, with tools that travel

The S.H.F.T.™ reset card, zone check-ins, tracking logs and the 18-tool workbook keep skills active between sessions; the seven-module self-paced eLearning runs standalone or as an adjunct.

05 Outcomes back to you

With consent — assessment summary and recommended pathway, six-week progress update, discharge summary, and a three-month outcome letter. Measures: IBS-SSS, DASS-21, VSI, ORS/SRS, EF™ Triage Tool (0–96).

The full menu

OFFER	FORMAT	BEST FOR
Psychoeducation, FAQs and starter tools	Free · online · no referral	Hesitant patients; the point-of-reassurance handout.
Introductory DGBI workshop	Half-day, full-day option	Green–amber; a first step into psychological care.
Foundations group series	Four weekly sessions · workbook	Amber–orange; the core programme.
Individual psychology	50 min · in person or telehealth	Orange–red, risk, complexity, group-unsuitable.
Self-paced eLearning	Seven modules · 12-month access	Motivated patients; adjunct to any tier.
Shared medical–psychology session	Joint 50-minute consultation	Complex, comorbid, pre- and post-surgical.

Fees and *contact.*

SERVICE	DURATION	FEE — NZD
Initial consultation and assessment	50 min	\$380
Follow-up / brief intervention	30 min	\$200
Extended follow-up (CBT, relaxation strategies)	50 min	\$325
Psychoeducation seminar group	90 min	TBC
Shared medical–psychology session	50 min	\$380

The patient pays at booking · Southern Cross affiliated · an insurer-reimbursement guide accompanies every booking confirmation · workshop, group and eLearning fees confirmed at enquiry.

CONTACT

Refer or discuss a case — consultant@sarahanticich.co.nz · executiveframe.co.nz · 15-minute case discussions welcome · Dr Sarah Anticich · Auckland · Christchurch · Queenstown · telehealth nationwide

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